# Rashid Mushkani

Curriculum vitae

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Research interests: democratic governance of AI; civic participation; public institutions and administrative accountability; pluralistic evaluation; urban planning and public space.

## Education

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| 2026 | Ph.D. (interdisciplinaire en aménagement), Université de Montréal. Thesis: *The urban right to AI: Pluralistic co-design and governance of public space.* Defended 24 August 2026. Supervisor: Shin Alexandre Koseki. arXiv:2608.23999. |
| 2019–2021 | M.Eng., Architecture and Civil Engineering, Toyohashi University of Technology, Japan. |
| 2012–2016 | B.Sc., Architecture, Kabul University, Afghanistan. |

## Languages

I teach, write and publish in English. I am able to teach, write and work in French, and I continue to strengthen the precision and range of my French in academic settings.

## Academic appointments and research experience

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| 2026–present | IVADO Postdoctoral Fellow, Université de Montréal. Supervisor: Catherine Régis, Faculty of Law. Project: *AI Pluralism Index: An interoperable framework for pluralism in civic AI.* |
| 2025–present | Lecturer, School of Urban Planning and Landscape Architecture, Université de Montréal. Master's course: Urbanisme international (URB 6850). |
| 2023–2025 | Researcher, AI4Humanity, Mila; participatory AI projects with Université de Montréal. Led a nine-person project team. |
| 2022–2025 | Researcher, UNESCO Chair in Urban Landscape, Université de Montréal. |
| 2017–2019 | Faculty member, Department of Architecture, Faculty of Engineering, Kabul University. |

## Peer-reviewed publications

Mushkani, R. (2026). Voices in the Loop: Mapping Participatory AI. *Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency*, 873–893. doi:10.1145/3805689.3812241.

Mushkani, R. (2026). Pluralistic-Alignment Urbanism: Operationalizing a Right to AI for Inclusive Public Space. *Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency*, 974–997. doi:10.1145/3805689.3812244.

Mushkani, R. (2026). Position: Prompts for Public-Sector LLMs Should Be Governed as Commons. *Proceedings of the 43rd International Conference on Machine Learning*, PMLR 306, 171572–171582. Position paper.

Mushkani, R. (2026). Position: Benchmarks for Vision–Language Models in Urban Perception Should Be Reliability-Aware and Negotiated. *Proceedings of the 43rd International Conference on Machine Learning*, PMLR 306, 171558–171571. Position paper.

Mushkani, R., and Koseki, S. (2026). Street review: A participatory AI-based framework for assessing streetscape inclusivity. *Cities*, 170, 106602. doi:10.1016/j.cities.2025.106602.

Mushkani, R., Berard, H., Ammar, T., and Koseki, S. (2026). Public perceptions of Montréal's streets: Implications for inclusive public space making and management. *Journal of Urban Management*, 15(1), 9–25. doi:10.1016/j.jum.2025.07.004.

Mushkani, R., Nayak, S., Berard, H., Cohen, A., Koseki, S., and Bertrand, H. (2025). LIVS: A Pluralistic Alignment Dataset for Inclusive Public Spaces. *Proceedings of the 42nd International Conference on Machine Learning*, PMLR 267, 45311–45341.

Mushkani, R., Berard, H., Cohen, A., and Koseki, S. (2025). Position: The Right to AI. *Proceedings of the 42nd International Conference on Machine Learning*, PMLR 267, 81876–81896. Position paper.

Mushkani, R., Berard, H., Ammar, T., Chatonnier, C., and Koseki, S. (2025). Co-Producing AI: Toward an Augmented, Participatory Lifecycle. *Proceedings of the AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society*, 8(2), 1785–1799. doi:10.1609/aies.v8i2.36674.

Mushkani, R., and Koseki, S. (2025). Intersecting perspectives: A participatory street review framework for urban inclusivity. *Habitat International*, 164, 103536. doi:10.1016/j.habitatint.2025.103536.

Gowaikar, S., Berard, H., Mushkani, R., and Koseki, S. (2025). From Efficiency to Equity: Measuring Fairness in Preference Learning. *Proceedings of the AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society*, 8(2), 1134–1143. doi:10.1609/aies.v8i2.36616.

Mushkani, R. A., and Ono, H. (2022). Urban planning, political system, and public participation in a century of urbanization: Kabul, Afghanistan. *Cogent Social Sciences*, 8(1), 2045452. doi:10.1080/23311886.2022.2045452.

Mushkani, R. A., and Ono, H. (2021). Spatial equity of public parks: A case study of Kabul City, Afghanistan. *Sustainability*, 13(3), 1516. doi:10.3390/su13031516.

Mushkani, R. A., and Ono, H. (2021). The role of land use and vitality in fostering gender equality in urban public parks: The case of Kabul city, Afghanistan. *Habitat International*, 118, 102462. doi:10.1016/j.habitatint.2021.102462.

## Other proceedings and workshop papers

Mushkani, R. (2026). Measuring What Matters: The AI Pluralism Index. *Proceedings of IASEAI Conference*, 2(1), 447–459. doi:10.1609/iaseai.v2i1.43044.

Mushkani, R. (2026). AI Pluralism and the Worlds It Misses. ICML 2026 Pluralistic Alignment Workshop. arXiv:2606.16167.

Gowaikar, S., Berard, H., Mushkani, R., Marchand, E. B., Ammar, T., and Koseki, S. (2024). AI-EDI-SPACE: A Co-designed Dataset for Evaluating the Quality of Public Spaces. CVPR Workshop on Responsible Data.

Nayak, S., Mushkani, R., Berard, H., Cohen, A., Koseki, S., and Bertrand, H. (2024). MID-Space: Aligning Diverse Communities' Needs to Inclusive Public Spaces. NeurIPS Workshop on Pluralistic Alignment. Oral presentation.

Koseki, S., Ammar, T., Mushkani, R., Berard, H., and Tannir, S. (2024). Évaluation algorithmique inclusive de la qualité des espaces publics. *SHS Web of Conferences*, 203, 01005. SCAN24. doi:10.1051/shsconf/202420301005.

## Accepted presentations

Mushkani, R., Berard, H., and Koseki, S. (2026). WeDesign+: Deliberative Visual AI for Public Space Planning. Accepted poster, ACM EAAMO 2026; scheduled 6 November 2026, presenter Hugo Berard.

Mushkani, R. (2026). Decision-Time Administrative Reason-Giving for U.S. Municipal AI: The Urban Reasonableness Layer. Accepted poster, ACM EAAMO 2026.

## Preprints

Mushkani, R. (2026). Traceable, Enforceable, and Compensable Participation: A Participation Ledger for People-Centered AI Governance. arXiv:2602.10916.

Mushkani, R. (2025). From Participation to Power: Institutional Designs that Give Communities Veto, Recourse, and Maintenance Seats. doi:10.2139/ssrn.5492609.

Mushkani, R. (2025). Urban AI Governance Must Embed Legal Reasonableness for Democratic and Sustainable Cities. arXiv:2508.12174.

Mushkani, R., Berard, H., and Koseki, S. (2025). WeDesign: Generative AI-Facilitated Community Consultations for Urban Public Space Design. arXiv:2508.19256.

Mushkani, R. (2025). Intersectoral Knowledge in AI and Urban Studies: A Framework for Transdisciplinary Research. arXiv:2508.07507.

Mushkani, R., Berard, H., and Koseki, S. (2025). Negotiative Alignment: Embracing Disagreement to Achieve Fairer Outcomes – Insights from Urban Studies. arXiv:2503.12613.

## Public writing and other publications

Mushkani, R. (2026). AI Can Help Residents Imagine Better Cities. It Can Also Leave Them Out. *Next City*, 29 June.

Koseki, S., and Mushkani, R. (2026). Des villes plus inclusives grâce à l'IA ? Oui, si les communautés gardent la main. *The Conversation*, 10 June. doi:10.64628/aap.wjuaanwuj.

Mushkani, R. (2022). Flere Fronter (Several fronts: Architecture at war). *Arkitekten*, Anneks.

Mushkani, R. A., and Ono, H. (2020). Public Spaces of Developing Countries Post COVID-19: A Reflection on Current Situation from Planning Perspective in Case of Kabul City, Afghanistan. *International Journal of Interdisciplinary Research and Innovations*, 8(3), 1–5.

## Teaching

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| Fall 2025 | URB 6850, Urbanisme international, Université de Montréal. Master's course, 3 credits, with a French-language syllabus and assessment instructions. Reflective essays, team case study and staged presentations. |
| 2023–2025 | Instructor, community co-creation workshops, Mila and Université de Montréal. Participatory design, discussion of AI and evaluation of public spaces. |
| Winter 2023 | Practical instructor (chargé de formation pratique), DIN 1043, Éléments de structure, Université de Montréal. Undergraduate course. |
| 2021–2022 | Architectural Design I–II, Toyohashi University of Technology. Undergraduate studio teaching. |
| 2017–2019 | Kabul University: Public Buildings and Adaptive Reuse (AR406); Heritage Conservation (AR421); Environmental Design and Society (AR422); History and Theory of Architecture (AR315). |

## Mentoring and community engagement

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| 2022–present | Daricha: informal mentoring and support for Afghan women pursuing higher education. Scholarship applications, remote academic support and discussion of study pathways. |
| 2023–present | Mentoring of master's and doctoral students on research projects, and work with community participants. |

## Selected scholarships and awards

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| 2026 | Finalist, Prix Personnalités de l'innovation sociale, Gouvernance et communautés, Maison de l'innovation sociale. |
| 2026 | Jeunes chercheurs, jeunes chercheuses award, Faculté de l'aménagement, Université de Montréal. |
| 2025 | Bourses en intelligence artificielle des Études supérieures et postdoctorales, Université de Montréal. |
| 2025 | Speed Science Contest, third prize, Mila. |
| 2024 | FRQ – Société et culture doctoral scholarship. |
| 2024 | Guy-Desbarats Excellence Award and Student Engagement Prize, Université de Montréal. |
| 2023 | FAVE Perseverance Award, Université de Montréal. |
| 2021–2022 | TUT-DC Fellowship, Toyohashi University of Technology. |
| 2021 | Young Researcher Award, Toyohashi University of Technology. |
| 2019–2021 | JICA scholarship, Japan International Cooperation Agency. |
| 2019 | Teaching Performance and Academic Excellence Award, Kabul University. |
| 2018 | Best Professor Award, Faculty of Engineering, Kabul University. |

## Selected project support

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| 2024–2025 | Mitacs Accelerate, applied research on inclusive AI for public spaces. |
| 2018–2019 | Architectural modelling workshop, Kabul University; support from the Royal Norwegian Embassy, co-led with the Faculty of Engineering. |

## Datasets and software

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| 2025 | LIVS, pluralistic alignment dataset for text-to-image models. |
| 2025 | StreetReview, participatory street review dataset and assessment framework. |
| 2025 | WeDesign+, prototype for facilitated visual deliberation in public-space planning. |
| 2025 | LayScience, plain-language research access tool. |
| 2024 | MID-Space, co-created dataset for public-space design evaluation. |

## Selected talks

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| 1 Oct 2026 | AI Pluralism: Models and Governance, FATE group, Mila. |
| 9 Jul 2026 | ICML 2026 poster presentations: Prompts for Public-Sector LLMs Should Be Governed as Commons; Benchmarks for Vision–Language Models in Urban Perception Should Be Reliability-Aware and Negotiated. |
| 3 May 2026 | Featured speaker, InDesCanada, Carleton University. |
| 2026 | AI Pluralism and the Worlds It Misses, poster, ICML 2026 Pluralistic Alignment Workshop. |
| 2026 | Participation Ledger: Traceable, Enforceable, and Compensable Participation for AI Governance, PAIRS 2026, online. |

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| 2026 | The Right to AI, Critical Science Reading Group, Mila. |
| 2026 | Measuring What Matters: The AI Pluralism Index, IASEAI 2026, Paris. |
| 3 Feb 2026 | AI Pluralism: What Models Do, Who Decides, and Why It Matters, AI Safety Montréal, at Université du Québec à Montréal. |
| 2025 | The Right to AI, Applied Machine Learning Days, EPFL, Lausanne. |
| 2025 | The Right to AI: Rethinking Participatory Approaches in AI, PAIRS Symposium, Sciences Po, Paris. |
| 2025 | Co-producing AI, Institute for Advanced Architecture of Catalonia, Barcelona. |
| 2025 | Social Application of AI, AI4Good Lab, online. |
| 2024 | Using AI to Design Inclusive Public Spaces, Innovate for Cities, Montréal. |
| 2023 | Benchmarking Inclusion: An Assessment Method, Spatial Justice in Practice Symposium, TU Delft. |
| 2021 | A century of participatory planning and governance, Asian Studies Online Consortium, Kyushu University. |

## Service

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| 2026–present | Member, Researcher Council, Digital Research Alliance of Canada. |
| 2025–2026 | Guest editor with Robert J. Chaskin and Shin Koseki, *Cities* special issue, The Politics of Spatial Inclusion in Cities. |
| 2025 | Reviewer, AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society. |
| 2024–2025 | Reviewer: ICML, ICLR, NeurIPS, CVPR, CHI, *Habitat International* and *Demography*; workshops at NeurIPS and AAAI. |
| 2024–present | Member and moderator, UNESCO Chairs on Social Inclusion in Cities. |
| 2023–present | Member, International Observatory on the Societal Impacts of AI and Digital Technologies (OBVIA). |
| 2025 | Volunteer, AI4Good Lab. |
| 2020–2022 | Moderator and contributor, Architectural Institute of Japan, Urban Planning and Design research committee. |

## Professional experience

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| 2026–present | Co-founder and CEO, Cocoon Lab, which develops AI tools for planning and building review. |
| 2016–2019 | Architect, Aga Khan Trust for Culture, Kabul. Chihilsitoon Garden and Kabul Riverfront projects. |